

1. PURPOSE

This policy establishes a structured framework for the continuous development and upgrading of technical and professional skills across all levels of the organization. In a rapidly evolving technology landscape, it is imperative that employees remain current with emerging tools, platforms, programming languages, frameworks, and industry best practices. This policy ensures the company remains competitive while empowering employees to grow professionally.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees including software engineers, data scientists, DevOps engineers, QA analysts, product managers, IT support staff, and associated technical roles across all departments and offices.

3. POLICY OBJECTIVES

- To foster a culture of continuous learning and self-improvement.
 - To align individual skill development with organizational technology goals and business strategy.
 - To reduce skill gaps identified during performance appraisals, project audits, or technology transitions.
 - To attract, retain, and motivate high-performing technology talent.
 - To ensure compliance with industry certifications and regulatory requirements where applicable.
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4. SKILLS ASSESSMENT

4.1 A formal skills assessment shall be conducted for every employee at least once annually, typically during the mid-year performance review cycle.

4.2 Assessments will evaluate competencies across three dimensions: technical skills (e.g., coding languages, cloud platforms, cybersecurity), soft skills (e.g., communication, leadership, collaboration), and domain knowledge (e.g., fintech, SaaS, enterprise systems).

4.3 Results of assessments shall be documented in the employee's Individual Development Plan (IDP) and reviewed jointly by the employee and their reporting manager.

5. ELIGIBLE LEARNING ACTIVITIES

The company recognizes and supports the following forms of skill development:

- Online courses and certifications (e.g., AWS, Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure, Coursera, Udemy for Business, LinkedIn Learning)
- Internal workshops, hackathons, and tech talks
- Conferences, seminars, and industry summits
- Postgraduate programs or executive education courses relevant to the role
- Mentorship and peer-learning programs
- Open-source contribution and internal innovation projects

6. FINANCIAL SUPPORT

6.1 Each employee is entitled to an annual Learning and Development (L&D) budget, allocated as follows:

Level	Annual L&D Budget
Junior (0–2 years)	₹20,000
Mid-level (3–6 years)	₹35,000
Senior / Lead (7+ years)	₹60,000
Manager / Architect	₹80,000

6.2 Expenses must be pre-approved by the reporting manager and the HR department before enrollment.

6.3 Reimbursement shall be processed within 30 working days of submission of valid proof of completion and payment receipts.

6.4 Employees who voluntarily resign within 12 months of completing a company-funded certification or course costing more than ₹25,000 shall be liable to repay 50% of the amount incurred.

7. TIME-OFF FOR LEARNING

7.1 Employees are entitled to up to 5 paid learning days per calendar year, separate from their annual leave entitlement, to attend approved training programs, boot camps, or examinations.

7.2 Requests for learning time-off must be submitted at least 7 working days in advance and are subject to project and team availability.

8. MANDATORY SKILLS UPGRADE REQUIREMENTS

8.1 Certain skill upgrades may be mandated by the organization based on technology adoption, compliance needs, or project requirements.

8.2 In such cases, the company shall bear 100% of the associated training costs and provide dedicated work hours for completion.

8.3 Employees are expected to complete mandatory training within the stipulated timeframe. Non-compliance without valid justification may result in a formal performance note.

9. CAREER DEVELOPMENT LINKAGE

9.1 Skills upgrade milestones shall be factored into promotion and increment decisions during the annual performance appraisal cycle.

9.2 Employees who consistently meet or exceed their Individual Development Plan targets shall be given priority consideration for internal role transitions, leadership programs, and high-visibility projects.

10. EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITIES

- Proactively identify skill gaps and discuss them with their manager.
 - Complete agreed training within committed timelines.
 - Share learnings with the team through knowledge-transfer sessions or internal documentation.
 - Maintain updated profiles on internal talent management platforms reflecting newly acquired skills and certifications.
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11. MANAGER RESPONSIBILITIES

- Conduct regular one-on-ones to discuss learning progress and career aspirations.
 - Recommend relevant and role-appropriate training opportunities.
 - Approve or escalate L&D requests in a timely manner.
 - Recognize and reward employees who demonstrate commitment to upskilling.
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12. POLICY REVIEW

This policy shall be reviewed annually by the HR and L&D teams in consultation with department heads to ensure alignment with the company's evolving technology strategy and talent objectives.

13. GRIEVANCES

Any disputes or concerns related to this policy shall be escalated to the HR Business Partner for resolution within 10 working days of the complaint being raised.

This document is intended for internal use only and forms part of the company's Employee Handbook.